

Spielberg's heartwarming *E.T. the Extra-Terrestrial* is **science fiction for all the family**; not so Ridley Scott's epic *Blade Runner*, a **neo-noir vision** of Los Angeles in 2019.

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1982

Blue Velvet achieves instant cult status for David Lynch's **surreal and subversive** take on Americana.

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1986

Pedro Almodóvar's black comedy, *Women on the Verge of a Nervous Breakdown*, wins the Spanish director a global following.

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1988

Set in 1920s China, *Raise the Red Lantern* seduces audiences worldwide with the intensity of its **visual and emotional power**.

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1991

1985

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The **Sundance Institute** hosts its inaugural movie festival in Utah, to champion independent and world cinema.

1987

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Angels alight in Berlin in Wim Wenders' *Wings of Desire*, two years before the fall of the Berlin Wall dividing East and West Germany.

1989

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Indies come of age with *Sex, Lies, and Videotape*, a breakthrough hit for studio Miramax and debut director Steven Soderbergh.

1992

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Disney's *Beauty and the Beast* is the **first animated movie** to be nominated for an Oscar for Best Picture.

a story that inspired equal dread with its wispy account of missing schoolgirls in the outback of 1900. Meanwhile, in an industrial pocket of Estonia, the great Russian director Andrei Tarkovsky was making *Stalker*, poised between science fiction and philosophy. These are movies that remain, even now, gloriously unfathomable.

New decade, new voices

In the 1980s, Wall Street traders and mainstream movies looked slicker than ever, but around the edges, directors still drilled down into what lies beneath. Perhaps nothing sums up that better than the fact that David Cronenberg—whose notorious “body horror” scenes were less disturbing than the psyches of his characters—was once offered the chance to make that

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Now more than ever we need to listen to each other and understand how we see the world, and cinema is the best medium for doing this.

Martin Scorsese
”

gung-ho landmark, *Top Gun* (1986). And then there was David Lynch—who, like Hitchcock before him, was unique enough to exist as a genre of his own, his movies driven

by the subconscious, and at least as surreal, funny, and disturbing as real dreams can be.

By the end of the 1980s, other voices were speaking up. Indie movies were in the ascendant, from Spike Lee tracking racial tensions in Brooklyn, to Steven Soderbergh training his lens on sexuality and relationships. From China, Zhang Yimou's *Raise the Red Lantern* was both a gorgeous period drama and a signal of a global future.

Meanwhile, cinema itself survived another attack on its very existence: just as TV had been supposed to leave it for dead in previous decades, so too was the rise of home video in the 1980s. In the battle between VHS and cinema, there was only one winner: new formats come and go, but the movies endure. ■